

“…EQUALITY IS PERHAPS AS HIGH AN AIM OF LIFE AS TRUTH OR BEAUTY…”

Ram Manohar Lohia was a well-respected writer, activist and leader of the socialist movement in India. Believing that the Congress was run by an upper-caste, English-speaking political class, he was one of the founders of the Socialist Party, and argued that India needed to empower lower-caste and tribal communities. To achieve this, he suggested that a strong reservation policy (60 per cent reservation) be implemented in employment and education. Lohia is remembered for his fierce and uncompromising criticism of the Nehru government’s policies, and for consistently putting social justice issues at the forefront of politics.

JYOTI BASU

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